

RESUF AHMED

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Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford King Center on Global Development, Stanford University

[Personal Webpage](#) | resuf@stanford.edu | [📧](#) [🐦](#)

CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Fellow
Stanford University

January 2026 -

EDUCATION

PhD Economics
HEC Lausanne, University of Lausanne
Advisors: Dominic Rohner and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya

2020 - 2025

MA Economics
Paris School of Economics

2018 - 2020

BA Economics
University of Delhi

2014 - 2017

RESEARCH

Field: Development Economics, Political Economics, Cultural Economics

Working Papers

From Reservation to Transformation: The Socioeconomic Impact of Political Quotas

Ancient Epics in the Television Age: Religious Identity and the Rise of Hindu Nationalism in India (with Dean Yang, Alessandro Saia, Akhila Kovvuri and Paul Brimble) (*NBER WP 33417*) *Under Review*

Leader Marches as an Opposition Electoral Strategy (with Feyaad Allie) *Under Review*

Technology and the Production of Justice: System-Wide Effects of Indonesia's E-Court Reform (with Sultan Mehmood and Alexandra Filimonova) *Under Review*

Work in Progress

Power-sharing, Segregation and Conflict (with Ekaterina Zhuravskaya, Saumitra Jha, Dominic Rohner, and Alessandro Saia)

Debunking Myths: Ancestral Narratives and Intergroup Cooperation in India (with Riccardo Ghidoni, Mariapia Mendola, Stefano Piasenti and Alessandro Saia)

Press & Public Engagement

Can digitising courts speed up justice without cutting corners?, September 2026, *VoxDev*

The Sunday morning broadcast that changed Indian democracy, March 2026, *VoxDev*

Decoding Bharat Jodo Yatra's impact on Karnataka Elections, May 2023, *Hindustan Times*

How the Ramayan TV Show Helped Shape a Singular Nationwide Hindu Identity, February 2025, *The Hindu* (coverage)

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

* (Presentation by co-author)

20th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI-Delhi

December 2025

* BSE Summer Forum - Political Economy, BSE (Spain)

July 2025

Eleventh ECINEQ Conference, World Bank Group and George Washington University

July 2025

Tokyo Conference on Institutions, Law, and Development, GRIPS, Japan)	June 2025
European Meeting on the Political Economy of South Asia, Naples	June 2025
* BREAD Conference on Development, Princeton University	May 2025
19th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI-Delhi	December 2024
Lewis Lab Graduate Student Workshop, University of Manchester	November 2024
Paris School of Economics	November 2024
ASREC Europe 2024	September 2024
ACES Summer School, Hong Kong	August 2024
IRES Graduate Workshop, LA (USA)	June 2024
Paris School of Economics	May 2024
ASREC 2024, Chapman University	March 2024
Delhi School of Economics	December 2023
18th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI-Delhi	December 2023
ASREC 2023 Workshop, Harvard University	March 2023
Graduate Student Seminar, Brown University	March 2023
17th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI-Delhi	December 2022
DSE Winter School 2022, Delhi School of Economics	December 2022
Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series (Z-PESS), ETH Zurich	November 2022
ISI Seminar, Indian Statistical Institute - Delhi	August 2022
Society for Economics Research in India Workshop, ISB Hyderabad	July 2022
Applied Economics Lunch Seminar, Paris School of Economics	April 2022
ASREC 2022 workshop (Online), Chapman University	April 2022
Public Economics and Policy Seminar, University of Lausanne	March 2022
ECON GSW Seminar, University of Zurich	October 2021

TEACHING

Development Economics	Fall 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022
MSc Economics, University of Lausanne	
Economic Analysis and Communication	Fall 2024, 2023, 2022, 2021
MSc Economics, University of Lausanne	
Statistics and Econometrics I	Fall 2024, 2023, 2022, 2021
BSc Economics, University of Lausanne	

AWARDS & HONOURS

Virginia Gray Graduate Student Research Award 2024 by the American Political Science Association
Doctoral Mobility Fellowship by the University of Lausanne - 30,000 USD
PhD Scholarship by the University of Lausanne for the year 2020 - 2025
PPD Grant 2019 by the Paris School of Economics
Charpak BCS Scholarship (Bourse de Couverture Sociale) by the Government of France. 2018-2020
Young India Fellowship 2017 by the Ashoka University - 700,000 INR (Declined)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *World Development*

SKILLS

Python, QGIS, STATA and R

Field Visits

Karnataka, India (January 2024)
Uttar Pradesh, India (March-May, 2025)